

Linguistic Flexibility Practice — SLT Instructor Protocol

Role: SLT Instructor | Track: Linguistic Flexibility | Version 1.0 | Effective: July 27, 2026

1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This SOP governs the Linguistic Flexibility (LF) practice cycle for SLT instructors using the B10 Practice Platform (B10-PP). It applies to pull-out sessions with individual students or very small groups working toward ILR 2+/3 oral English proficiency.

The LF track addresses the sub-sentential and syntactic features that distinguish ILR 2+ production from ILR 3 production: control of word forms across derivational families, syntactic variety, the ability to combine ideas into well-connected arguments, and stance and perspective marking. These features are frequently the limiting factor in students who demonstrate adequate content knowledge in ESO practice but cannot yet sustain ILR 3 register across a full response.

The LF track is organized around **four subcategories**, each targeting a distinct linguistic skill. Practice is structured as a **skill cycle** — the SLT instructor introduces one subcategory per cycle, assigns independent practice between sessions, and evaluates mastery before moving to the next. Depth of practice within each subcategory takes priority over coverage of all four.

LF QUESTIONS — PRE-PILOT STATUS

The 32 LF practice questions (8 per subcategory) have been identified, sequenced, approved, and are available in the four LF subcategory folders in the Linguistic Flexibility section of the platform.

2. THE FOUR LF SUBCATEGORIES

The four subcategories are presented in the recommended default sequence. This sequence follows a bottom-up linguistic complexity progression — each subcategory builds on the skills developed in the previous one. SLT instructors may enter at any point based on diagnostic observation, but should document skipped subcategories for targeting in subsequent cycles.

Order	Subcategory	Tag	Core Skill	Prerequisite
1	Word Form Flexibility	WFF	Morphological control — derivational families, nominalization, adjectival and verbal forms	None — recommended starting point

2	Structural Variation	SV	Syntactic reordering — clause fronting, embedding, coordination, avoiding repetitive structure	Word Form Flexibility
3	Sentence Combining	SC	Idea integration — combining arguments into complex, cohesive utterances	Structural Variation
4	Perspective Integration	PI	Register and stance — embedding multiple viewpoints, signaling stance lexically and syntactically	Sentence Combining

ON THE SEQUENCE

Word Form Flexibility is the recommended starting point for all students new to the LF track, regardless of apparent proficiency level. Errors at the word form level are frequently masked in fluent speakers and only become visible under the production demands of ILR 3 ESO tasks. Beginning here ensures the foundation is solid before syntactic and discourse-level demands are introduced.

DIAGNOSTIC OVERRIDE

If scaffold feedback from a student's ESO/Frames attempts on the instructor dashboard consistently flags a specific LF subcategory as the limiting factor — or if instructor observation identifies a clear gap — the SLT instructor may enter the sequence at that subcategory. Document the entry point and note skipped subcategories as targets for the next cycle.

3. THE SKILL CYCLE

Each LF subcategory is practiced through a two-phase skill cycle. The cycle length is determined by student mastery, not by a fixed number of sessions.

Phase	When	What Happens	Go to Section
Phase 1 — Introduction Session	First session on a new LF subcategory	Introduce the subcategory; in-session attempt(s); immediate debrief; assign between-session practice	Section 4.1
Phase 2 — Follow-up Session(s)	Subsequent sessions on the same subcategory	Debrief between-session attempts; mastery check; assign remaining questions or advance	Section 4.2

SESSION FREQUENCY AND PACING

SLT sessions typically occur once or twice per week. Between-session practice (3–5 questions assigned after Phase 1) provides the primary volume of independent production. The instructor's role in Phase 2 is evaluation and direction, not re-instruction. If a student requires re-instruction on the same subcategory, that is a signal to slow the pacing, not to skip ahead.

4. SESSION PROCEDURES

4.1 — Phase 1: Introduction Session

You are beginning a session on a new LF subcategory. The student has not yet practiced this skill on the platform. Proceed in the following order.

1 Identify the target subcategory.

Select the LF subcategory for this cycle based on the default sequence (Section 2) or diagnostic observation. If this is the student's first session on the LF track, begin with Word Form Flexibility unless a specific gap has been identified.

2 Open the subcategory's reference HTML together.

Navigate to the Linguistic Flexibility section of the platform at b10-practice-platform.web.app/b10_practice_platform/. Open the reference HTML for the target subcategory. Read through it with the student — do not lecture from it. The reference is the instructional material; your role is to orient the student to how it works and what it is asking them to do.

3 Model the skill with one question in-session.

Select the first question from the subcategory's question bank. Walk through the task with the student before they record: identify the specific LF demand in the question, apply the reference HTML's guidance to plan a response, then have the student record. Do not record yourself — the model is the planning process, not the response.

4 Debrief the in-session attempt immediately.

After the student records, review the transcript together on the platform. Focus the debrief on the specific LF skill targeted by this subcategory. WFF: Did the student deploy varied word forms from the same derivational family? Where did they default to a single form? SV: Did sentence structure vary? Were there opportunities for fronting or embedding the student did not take? SC: Were ideas combined into connected utterances, or did the student produce a series of short, unconnected sentences? PI: Did the student signal stance and perspective explicitly? Were multiple viewpoints embedded within the same utterance or presented sequentially?

5 Assign between-session practice (3–5 questions).

Assign 3–5 questions from the current subcategory's question bank for the student to complete independently before the next session. For once-weekly sessions, 4–5 questions is appropriate. For twice-weekly, 3 questions is sufficient. Remind the student to use the reference HTML while practicing — the goal at this stage is accurate application of the skill, not speed or independence.

6 Set expectations for the next session.

Inform the student that the next session will begin by reviewing their between-session attempts. They should be prepared to discuss what they found easy or difficult about applying the skill independently.

4.2 — Phase 2: Follow-up Session(s)

You are beginning a session on a subcategory the student has already been introduced to. They have completed between-session practice attempts. Proceed in the following order.

1 Review between-session attempts via the instructor dashboard.

Before the session begins, open the instructor dashboard and locate the student's recent submissions in the LF subcategory folder. Note the scores and review one or two transcripts. Identify a strong attempt and an attempt with a visible gap — you will use both in the debrief.

2 Open the debrief with the strong attempt.

Play the audio of the strongest between-session attempt. Review the transcript with the student. Identify specifically what the student did well — name the LF feature and where in the response it appears. This calibrates the student to the target standard before gaps are discussed.

3 Debrief a gap attempt.

Play the audio of an attempt with a visible LF gap. Review the transcript. Use the subcategory-specific debrief questions from Phase 1, Step 4. Ask the student to identify the gap before naming it yourself — productive self-diagnosis is the target skill at this stage.

4

Conduct the mastery check.

Based on the between-session attempts and the in-session debrief, evaluate whether the student has demonstrated sufficient command of this LF subcategory to advance.

MASTERY STANDARD

The student consistently demonstrates the target LF skill across multiple attempts without instructor prompting. Errors are occasional, not systematic. The skill is visible in the response without the student having to stop and apply it consciously.

✓ MASTERY MET — ADVANCE

Move to the next LF subcategory in the sequence. Begin a new Phase 1 Introduction Session at the next meeting. Note the completed subcategory in your session records.

→ MASTERY NOT YET MET — CONTINUE

Assign the remaining questions from the current subcategory's bank (up to the 8-question limit). Schedule another follow-up session. If the student has exhausted all 8 questions without meeting the mastery standard, conduct an additional in-session attempt and discuss the specific persistent gap before reassigning selected questions for a second pass.

5

Assign next between-session practice.

If continuing in the same subcategory: assign 2–3 remaining questions from the bank. If advancing: inform the student which subcategory is next and direct them to preview the reference HTML before the next session.

5. LF SUBCATEGORY REFERENCE

Each entry below provides a skill description, ILR 3 rationale, debrief focus, and the question bank for that subcategory.

Word Form Flexibility

WFF

Skill description: The student varies word forms across a derivational family — moving fluidly between nominal, adjectival, verbal, and adverbial forms of the same root — to achieve precision, cohesion, and register appropriate to ILR 3 academic/policy discourse.

ILR 3 rationale: ILR 3 production requires sustained use of abstract, precise vocabulary. Students locked into a single word form produce output that reads as ILR 2+ in register even when the content is adequate. Word form control is the most discrete and teachable LF skill — errors are visible and correction is concrete.

DEBRIEF FOCUS

Did the student deploy varied word forms from the same derivational family? Where did they default to a single form? Where would a nominalization, adjectival form, or alternate verb form have increased precision or register?

Question bank (8 questions):

EDU-013 GOV-019 TEC-009 ENV-006 HLT-029 ECN-003 JUS-016 SOC-003

Suggested Phase 1 in-session question: EDU-013. Suggested between-session assignment: GOV-019, TEC-009, ENV-006, HLT-029 (4 for once-weekly; 3 for twice-weekly).

Structural Variation

SV

Skill description: The student varies clause and sentence structure across a response — using fronting, subordination, embedding, and coordination to avoid syntactic repetition and to foreground information rhetorically.

ILR 3 rationale: Repetitive subject-verb-object structure signals ILR 2+ even when vocabulary is strong. ILR 3 production requires syntactic flexibility — the ability to reorder, subordinate, and embed in ways that serve the argument. Structural variation is the syntactic counterpart to word form control.

DEBRIEF FOCUS

Did sentence structure vary across the response? Were there opportunities for fronting, embedding, or subordination that the student did not take? Where did repetitive structure flatten the argument or reduce register?

Question bank (8 questions):

HLT-002 ECN-019 GOV-020 INT-010 TEC-005 ENV-004 JUS-006 CUL-004

Suggested Phase 1 in-session question: HLT-002. Suggested between-session assignment: ECN-019, GOV-020, INT-010, TEC-005.

Sentence Combining

SC

Skill description: The student combines multiple ideas into complex, cohesive utterances — using relative clauses, participial phrases, apposition, and logical connectors to connect ideas that would otherwise appear as a series of short, disconnected sentences.

ILR 3 rationale: A connected, well-organized argument is a defining feature of ILR 3 production. A response of well-formed but unconnected sentences reads as ILR 2+ — the ideas are present but the reasoning does not hang together. Sentence combining is the productive skill that makes idea integration visible in spoken output. It requires both word form control and structural flexibility, which is why it follows those subcategories in the default sequence.

DEBRIEF FOCUS

Were ideas combined into complex utterances, or did the student produce a series of short, unconnected sentences? Where could two or three ideas have been connected into one statement? Where does the lack of combining weaken the argument's flow and coherence?

Question bank (8 questions):

WRK-001 ENV-021 HLT-030 ECN-015 GOV-017 INT-015 TEC-021 CUL-009

Suggested Phase 1 in-session question: WRK-001. Suggested between-session assignment: ENV-021, HLT-030, ECN-015, GOV-017.

Perspective Integration

PI

Skill description: The student embeds multiple viewpoints within a single utterance — using reported speech frames, concessive structures, epistemic markers, and stance adverbials to signal whose perspective is being represented and how the speaker positions themselves relative to it.

ILR 3 rationale: ILR 3 ESO production requires the speaker to manage multiple perspectives simultaneously — presenting a position, acknowledging counterarguments, and signaling their own stance within a coherent argument. Students who can only present viewpoints sequentially are operating at ILR 2+. Perspective integration is the capstone LF skill — it presupposes all three prior subcategories.

DEBRIEF FOCUS

Did the student signal stance and perspective explicitly? Were multiple viewpoints embedded within the same utterance, or presented sequentially? Where did the student miss an opportunity to use a concessive structure, epistemic marker, or reported speech frame to integrate perspective?

Question bank (8 questions):

EDU-008 HLT-003 SOC-002 JUS-013 ECN-002 ENV-020 CUL-003 GOV-016

Suggested Phase 1 in-session question: EDU-008. Suggested between-session assignment: HLT-003, SOC-002, JUS-013, ECN-002.

6. CYCLE RESET AND RE-ENTRY

After a student completes all four subcategories, the cycle resets. Re-entry follows the same default sequence (WFF → SV → SC → PI), but the demand level increases: the student is now expected to deploy each LF skill with greater fluency, less reliance on the reference HTML, and greater integration across subcategories within a single response.

RE-ENTRY STANDARD

On a second pass through a subcategory, the mastery standard is higher: the reference HTML should function as confirmation, not initiation. A student who still requires the reference HTML to produce the target LF feature has not fully proceduralized the skill from the first cycle. Note this and adjust pacing — more in-session practice, fewer between-session questions assigned at once.

LF SCORING RUBRICS — IN DEVELOPMENT

Scoring rubrics for each LF subcategory are in development and will be integrated into the platform scaffold feedback system prior to full pilot expansion. Once deployed, scaffold feedback for LF attempts will function identically to discourse frame scaffold feedback — diagnostic and subcategory-specific, with the score remaining holistic. Until rubrics are deployed, SLT instructors should use the debrief focus questions in Section 5 as the primary evaluative framework.

7. RELATIONSHIP TO THE ESO/FRAMES TRACK

The LF track is a support track, not a parallel track. Its purpose is to develop the sub-sentential and syntactic skills that allow a student to execute discourse frame structures at ILR 3 register. Students who are struggling to achieve ILR 3 scores on ESO/Frames attempts despite adequate content knowledge are the primary referral population for SLT pull-out sessions.

- **Referral source:** Main Instructor observation, scaffold feedback patterns on the instructor dashboard, or student self-report of difficulty with specific LF features.
- **Coordination:** SLT instructors should communicate mastery progress to the Main Instructor so that LF gains can be reinforced in ESO/Frames practice. A student who has completed WFF should be expected to demonstrate improved word form control in their next ESO attempt.
- **Dashboard access:** SLT instructors use the same instructor dashboard at b10-practice-platform.web.app/b10_practice_platform/ to view student submissions, scores, transcripts, and scaffold feedback across all tracks — not only LF attempts.

8. ADMINISTRATIVE NOTES

- **Session length:** Pull-out sessions are typically 30–50 minutes. Phase 1 Introduction Sessions require the full session. Phase 2 Follow-up Sessions may be shorter depending on the number of between-session attempts to debrief.
- **Student credentials:** Students log in with their B10-PP ID and password. If a student cannot log in, contact the Main Instructor — passwords cannot be reset and re-enrollment requires the student's B10-PP ID.
- **Submission window:** Student audio is retained for 72 hours. Review between-session attempts before this window closes.
- **Session records:** Maintain a brief record of which LF subcategory each student is working on, their current phase, and the number of questions completed. This is especially important for students who see multiple SLT instructors across a course.
- **Question bank limit:** Each subcategory contains 8 questions. If a student exhausts the bank without meeting the mastery standard, conduct an additional in-session attempt using a question from the general ESO bank and apply the same LF debrief focus.

- **LF reference HTMLs:** Available in the Linguistic Flexibility section of the platform. Each HTML is subcategory-specific and contains skill guidance, examples, and phrase-level support. Students may use these as a reference during between-session practice.